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China Communications Infrastructure

Our thoughts on Corning GlassBridge™ implication

CITI'S TAKE

Corning's GlassBridge™, formally presented on 24 June 2026, introduces an IOX waveguide-based fiber-to-PIC connector targeting NPO and CPO architectures as an evolutionary substitute for iFAU. We believe the current CPO solutions (Quantum and Spectrum) are finalized for mass production and unlikely to be affected. 2H27 solution is not likely to be replaced as the design is going to be confirmed in 2H26. We see lots of uncertainty for GlassBridge before proven qualification, reliability test and yield ramp. Among our covered names, **TFC's** long-term risk in iFAU is well contained by its ramping active optical engines' contribution. **DSBJ**, **Eoptolink**, **Accelink** and **T&S** remain largely unaffected.

GlassBridge™ Technology for Scalable Fiber-to-PIC Connectivity

Corning formally presented GlassBridge™ on 24 June 2026. GlassBridge uses wafer-level ion-exchange (IOX) waveguides embedded in a glass connector body to bridge the size mismatch between silicon photonic chip waveguides and optical fiber cores, targeting next-generation optical architectures including NPO, CPO, and high-density photonic modules. This new technique represented an evolution solution to substitute the iFAU in CPO architecture.

Limited near-to-mid-term impact

We believe the design of current CPO generations (Quantum and Spectrum) are finalized and not likely to be affected. We believe 2H27 CPO solution for Rubin Ultra Kyber is likely to be confirmed later this year and it's not likely to be replaced by the newly unveiled GlassBridge solution. There are still lots of uncertainty for GlassBridge given it requires CPO/NPO evaluation period and field test reliability on high-speed AI cluster system. It's unlikely to impact in next 1-2 years. Along with CPO and NPO commercializing through 2028–2030, GlassBridge may compete for incremental iFAU in new deployments, not the existing installed base. Beyond 2030, if wafer-level photonic packaging matures in yield and loss performance, there is possibility that the passive optical component industry faces a genuine paradigm shift from physical micro-assembly toward semiconductor-grade process integration.

On the ecosystem & standards context, adopting GlassBridge requires PIC designers to restructure optical beachfront layouts, redesign spot-size converters, and modify bump structures. We believe the switching costs create powerful inertia to limit GlassBridge's near-term penetration.

Business Impact Assessment for China's Optics Names

See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations

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GlassBridge presents varied strategic implications based on supply chain positioning for our covered optics names. For transceiver integrator and assembler **Eoptolink**, it serves neutrally as an alternative upstream component with limited direct substitution impact. **DSBJ** and **Accelink** also remain shielded, as their core competitive advantage lies in their active optical chips. **T&S Communications** focuses on passive optical components such as MT ferrules and fiber shuffle boxes, and may not benefit or get impact from the GlassBridge given the decoupling risk with Corning. For **TFC**, the long-term substitution threat to its iFAU segment is mitigated by its diversified revenue mix. TFC's primary growth engine has pivoted to active optical engines which we project to contribute >70% of revenue in 2026E-2028E.

Companies Mentioned:

Accelink Technologies (002281.SZ; Rmb240.34; 3; 26 Jun 26; 15:00) | Corning Incorporated (GLW.N; US\$221.05; 1; 26 Jun 26; 16:00) | Dongshan Precision (002384.SZ; Rmb260.32; 1; 26 Jun 26; 15:00) | Eoptolink Technology (300502.SZ; Rmb566.0; 1; 26 Jun 26; 15:00) | Suzhou TFC Optical Communication (300394.SZ; Rmb318.0; 1; 26 Jun 26; 15:00) | T&S Communications (300570.SZ; Rmb234.1; 3; 26 Jun 26; 15:00)

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